The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:30 pm CDT on Wednesday 21 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Saturday 24 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A slow moving high pressure system in the Tasman Sea maintains a ridge across eastern parts of the state. A trough of low pressure is forecast to move into the west on Thursday, and slowly move eastwards on Friday. Another trough and multiple cold fronts move over the state over the weekend.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northwest to northeasterly in the morning then tending south to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore later in the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning, then increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny morning. The chance of a thunderstorm inshore in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 15 to 20 knots in the early morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm at night.

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Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots in the early morning then becoming variable in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots before dawn then tending southerly 15 to 20 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots in the early morning then becoming variable in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then tending southerly in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots increasing to 20 knots before turning southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northwest to northeasterly in the morning then becoming variable below 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending southwesterly in the morning then tending southerly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

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Winds: South to southwesterly below 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending southerly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending east to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots south of Port MacDonnell early in the morning. Winds turning north to northwesterly in the late morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: North to northwesterly about 10 knots becoming west to southwesterly in the morning then tending south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: South to southwesterly below 10 knots tending west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the day then tending south to southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the late afternoon. Winds tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending southeast to southwesterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending southerly 15 to 20 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell

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to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly below 10 knots during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Northeast to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northeasterly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CDT Wednesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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